The Fox and the Grapes

One hot summer afternoon a hungry fox was walking through an orchard when he saw a bunch of ripe grapes hanging from a vine that had been trained over a high branch. The grapes looked so sweet and full of juice that his mouth began to water.

"Just the thing to quench my thirst," he said to himself, and taking a few steps back, he ran and jumped, but he missed the bunch by a long way.

He turned around and tried again, and then again, each time jumping a little higher than before. still he could not reach them. At last, tired and with his paws aching, he sat down and looked up at the grapes in disgust.

"What a fool I am," he said. "Those grapes are sour and not worth all this trouble. I am sure they would only give me a stomach ache." And he walked away with his nose in the air, as if he had never wanted them at all.

Moral

It is easy to pretend you do not want something once you find out you cannot have it. People often speak badly of the things they fail to get, instead of admitting that they tried and could not succeed.